Some of the Basseri tribesmen who had gradually abandoned nomadism for greater sedentism – mostly due to land ownership and agriculture – nonetheless exhibited "a continuing emotional interest in and identification with nomad life and ways" (Barth 1961: 106). Cf. also Barfield 1993: 96–97. In the case of the imperial Shansabanis, the *il-rah* could have been more a convenience and haptic trace of their pre-imperial ancestors, rather than a subsistence necessity, perhaps even compelled by many nomadic societies' ambivalence if not outright disdain toward sedentism (cf. Golden 2013: 22, 51).

30. Cf. Thomas 2018: 37. Tellingly, Thomas's monograph (2018: 1–2 and notes, 146–150, also 315–319) confronts Jam-Firuzkuh's lingering ambiguity in its opening pages and closes with plausible explanations of it. I am grateful to Warwick Ball (pers. comm., April 2020) for his observations on the two sites' suitability as the summer "capital."
31. Cf. Thomas 2018: 19, 40, esp. 149, for hypotheses regarding the Shansabanis' *garm-sir* destination. Recently, W. Ball (pers. comm., April 2020) proposed a few other sites as possible over-wintering "capitals" for the Shansabanis, including Qala'-yi Qaisar (Ball 2019: No. 875). Among the most promising of these could be Shahr-i Kuhna, about 100 km south of Taiwara: not only does it have the discernible *arg-shahristan* (round citadel–quadrangular settlement) plan – indicating pre-Islamic origins – it is also in the vicinity of Ziyarat-i Imam, a probable Ghaznavid-period shrine (*ziyarat*) of the late eleventh century. See Thomas 2018: 253; Ball 2019: Nos. 1047, 1130, 1267.
32. The above-mentioned documentary tours of Afghanistan were all principally carried out during the first three quarters of the twentieth century, as access to the country as a whole became more limited after the Soviet invasion of 1979. Wannell nonetheless pursued an impressive itinerary in 1989–1990 (cf. Wannell 2002). Constituting the bulk of documentation still available on Ghur and many other parts of the country, these archives have been invaluable for me given the inaccessibility of large parts of Afghanistan during my 2011 fieldwork. Cf. Thomas (2018: 113ff.) for a thorough summary of the available data and interpretations of southern Ghur's built remains.
33. Herberg 1982: 80–81.
34. Bosworth 1961; Edwards 1991: 90.
35. Juzjani **v**ol. I, 1963: 332 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 331–332); see also O'Neal 2013: 40 and *passim*; O'Neal 2016a. An exception would be Herberg's (1982: 83) dating: based on what he saw as the stylistic and technical consistency of decorative motifs on the surviving structures, he proposed that they were "part of a chronologically restricted building programme, probably that of Baha al-Din," no doubt also relying on Juzjani's report of this ruler's directions to building four fortresses on the borders of "Ghur, Garmsir, Gharjistan, and the mountain tract of Hirat." This dating would place southern Ghur's fortifications in the mid-twelfth century, just after the ruler's "completion of … edifices and the royal palaces" of Firuzkuh. However, Herberg provided no further evidence for his assertions in the form of comparable examples, or any further reasons for a seemingly instantaneous fortification of the landscape in this period.
36. Ball 2002: 41–44; see also Edwards 2015: 98–99. Although focused around